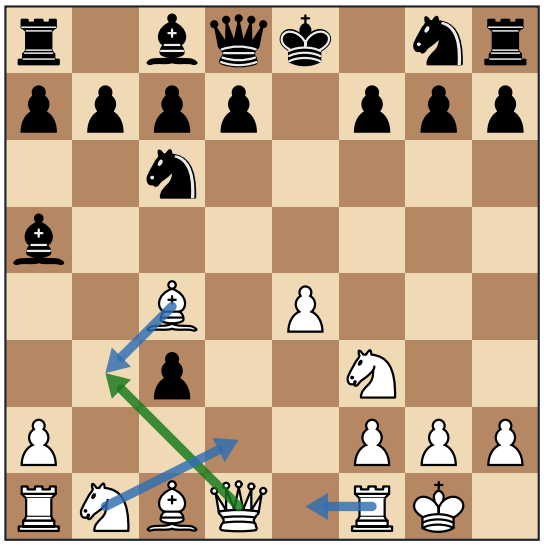
Italian Game

ECO C50-C59 | 187 named lines | Italian / Two Knights family

In one sentence: A flexible, classical center-building opening aiming at f7, with little forced theory in the quiet Giuoco Pianissimo.

Memory pattern: Bc4, Nf3, c3, d3, O-O, Re1: then reroute the knight and strike with d4.



Main line: 1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 Bxb4 5.c3 Ba5 6.d4 exd4 7.O-O dxc3

Key ideas

1. The bishop on c4 eyes f7; the center is built with c3, d3 and then d4.
2. Giuoco Pianissimo: slow maneuvering with a4, h3, Re1 and Nbd2-f1-g3.
3. Evans Gambit and Moller Attack give sharper play.
4. Black frees the game with ...d5 or ...Na5, or fights for e4 after Nf6.
5. Two Knights: avoid the Fried Liver theory with d3 (4.d3).

Reading the diagram

Blue arrows = thematic plan moves for the side to move. Green arrow = engine's best move.
Engine at the end of the main line: **+0.51** (slightly better for White, depth 18). Best: Qb3.

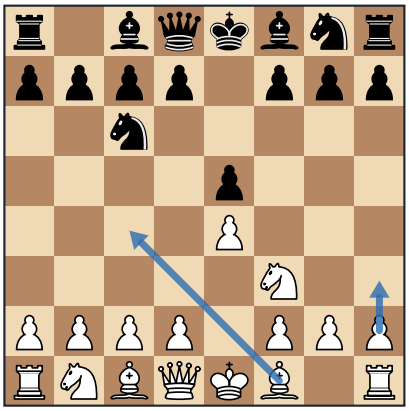
The five coach questions

1. Ideal pawn structure?	A flexible centre (c3/d3/e4) with the bishop on c4 eyeing f7. Often a slow, closed-ish structure where d4 is the central break.
2. Where does my king go?	Castle kingside early; the bishop on c4 and the knight on f3 support play against f7.
3. Best minor pieces?	White: Bc4/b3, Nbd2-f1-g3, Re1, Qe2. Black: Bc5/Be7, Nc6, ...d6/...d5.
4. Main middlegame plan?	White builds with c3-d3, then d4 or a kingside regroup; Black frees the game with ...d5 or ...Na5.
5. What does my opponent want?	White wants d4 at the right time; Black wants ...d5 for equality or to trade the bishop.

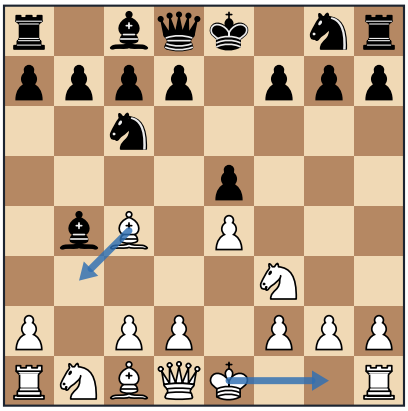
The main line, move by move

Most common continuation in the database: 1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 Bxb4 5.c3 Ba5 6.d4 exd4 7.O-O dxc3

Move	Why it is played
1. e4	Occupies the center with a pawn.
1... e5	Occupies the center with a pawn.
2. Nf3	Develops the knight to f3.
2... Nc6	Develops the knight to c6.
3. Bc4	Aim at f7. Develops the bishop to c4.
3... Bc5	Develops the bishop to c5.
4. b4	Evans gambit space. Gains space on the wing.
4... Bxb4	Captures on b4 to trade or win material.
5. c3	Prepare d4. Pawn move that supports the center or prepares a break.
5... Ba5	Repositions the bishop to a more active square.
6. d4	Central break. Occupies the center with a pawn.
6... exd4	Pawn capture: challenges the center and opens lines.
7. O-O	Castles: the king reaches safety and the rook joins the center.
7... dxc3	Pawn capture: challenges the center and opens lines.



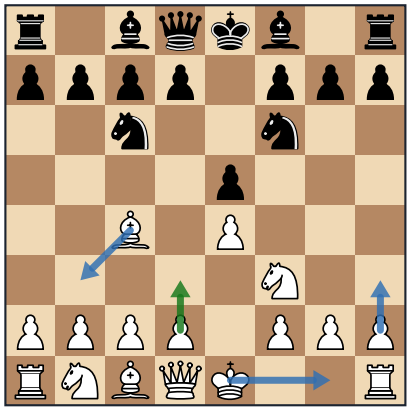
After 1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6



After c6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 Bxb4

Key variations

The most important named branches (ranked by how much theory lies beneath them). Diagram arrows: blue = plan moves, green = Stockfish.

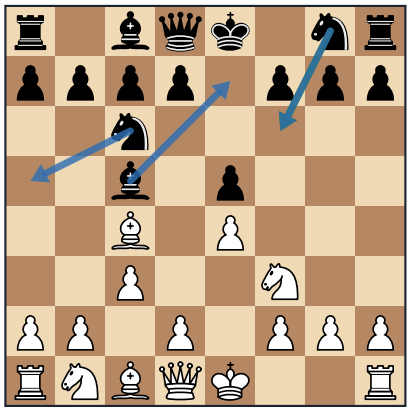


Position after the line

Two Knights Defense C55 | 46 lines

`1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6`

Stockfish: **+0.20** (equal, depth 15). Best next move: d3.
What to look for: Nf3 (develop); Bc4 (aim at f7); c3 (prepare d4)
Sub-variations: Polerio Defense, Max Lange Attack, Traxler Counterattack, Modern Bishop's Opening

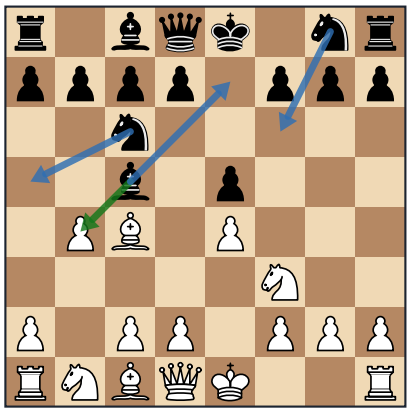


Position after the line

Classical Variation C53 | 45 lines

`1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.c3`

Stockfish: **+0.14** (equal, depth 16). Best next move: Nf6.
What to look for: Nc6 (develop); Nf6 (hit e4); Bc5 (develop actively)
Sub-variations: Giuoco Pianissimo, Greco Gambit, Albin Gambit, Center Holding Variation

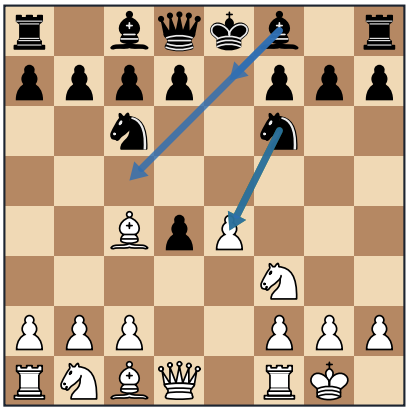


Position after the line

Evans Gambit C51 | 41 lines

`1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4`

Stockfish: **-0.16** (equal, depth 15). Best next move: Bxb4.
What to look for: Nc6 (develop); Nf6 (hit e4); Bc5 (develop actively)
Sub-variations: Compromised Defense, Anderssen Variation, McDonnell Defense, Fontaine Countergambit

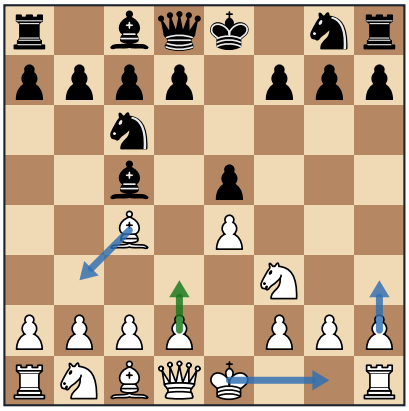


Position after the line

Scotch Gambit C56 | 14 lines

`1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 4.d4 exd4 5.O-O`

Stockfish: **-0.15** (equal, depth 18). Best next move: Nxe4.
What to look for: Nc6 (develop); Nf6 (hit e4); Bc5 (develop actively)
Sub-variations: Max Lange Attack, Anderssen Attack, Canal Variation, Double Gambit Accepted

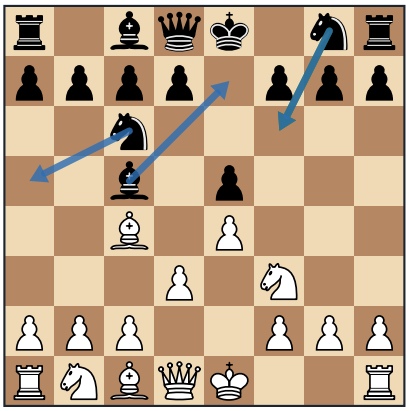


Position after the line

Giuoco Piano C50 | 10 lines

`1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5`

Stockfish: **+0.20** (equal, depth 17). Best next move: d3.
What to look for: Nf3 (develop); Bc4 (aim at f7); c3 (prepare d4)
Sub-variations: Aitken Variation, Bernstein Variation, Cracow Variation, Greco's Attack



Position after the line

Giuoco Pianissimo C50 | 9 lines

`1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.d3`

Stockfish: **+0.17** (equal, depth 19). Best next move: Nf6.
What to look for: Nc6 (develop); Nf6 (hit e4); Bc5 (develop actively)
Sub-variations: Canal Variation, Dubois Variation, Italian Four Knights Variation, Lucchini Gambit

Detailed repertoire notes

Italian Game (Giuoco Pianissimo) (C50-C54, White)

```
1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.c3 Nf6 5.d3 d6 6.O-O O-O 7.Re1 a6 8.a4
```

Idea: Build a d3-c3-e4 pawn center, then redeploy the knight and play d4 when ready. Keeps winning chances without heavy memorization.

Structure: Pawns c3/d3/e4 against d6/e5. The d4 break either opens the position for bishops or gains space if Black allows d4-d5.

Pieces: Bb3 targets f7, knight d2-f1-g3 (or e3), queen on e2, rook e1 supporting e4.

Plan: a4 (stops ...b5), h3 (stops ...Bg4), Nbd2-f1-g3, then d4. Black's own freeing moves are ...d5 and ...Nh5-f4.

King: Castle kingside by move 6, then build d3-c3 behind it. **Opponent:** ...d5 to free the game, or ...Na5 to trade your bishop.

Watch out: After ...Na5 retreat the bishop to a2 or b5; do not drop the bishop pair for nothing.

Expert and coach view

What a coach would tell you

Aim for c3 and d3, castle, then reroute the knight to g3 or e3 and play d4 when the timing is right. Understand that this is a maneuvering opening: plan before you move.

Why play it

A flexible, classical center-building opening aiming at f7, with little forced theory in the quiet Giuoco Pianissimo.

Typical mistakes

- Playing d4 too early without c3 support and losing the e4 pawn.
- Retreating the bishop to b3 and then neglecting the center.
- Falling for ...Nxe4 or ...d5 tactics when e4 is not defended.

Typical tactics and traps

- Fried Liver Attack (Nxf7) in the Two Knights after 4.Ng5 d5 5.exd5 Nxd5 6.Nxf7.
- The ...Nxe4 trick when d3 has not been played and the Re1 pin disappears.

Endgame and middlegame outlook

Often quiet and balanced; wins come from small advantages in pawn structure and piece activity.

Study checklist

[ ] Play the main line on a board and say each move's purpose aloud.

[ ] Learn the five coach questions by heart; answer them without notes.

[ ] Drill two sub-variations until the moves feel automatic.

[ ] Play three games with the opening, then review where you left theory.

[ ] Re-read the traps page the day before a tournament.

The opening tree

Every named line in this family as a tree. Gray moves are inherited from the parent; green after the arrow are the new moves that define the variation. Large green dots mark branches with 10 or more lines.

- **Italian Game (all lines)** C50
  `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4`
  - **Anti-Fried Liver Defense** C50
    `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 -> 3...h6`
  - **Blackburne-Kostić Gambit** C50
    `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 -> 3...Nd4`
  - **Giuoco Piano** C50
    `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 -> 3...Bc5`
    - **Cracow Variation** C54
      `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 -> 4.c3 Nf6 5.d4 exd4 6.cxd4 Bb4 7.Kf1`
    - **Greco's Attack** C54
      `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 -> 4.c3 Nf6 5.d4 exd4 6.cxd4 Bb4 7.Nc3`
    - **Rosentreter Variation** C54
      `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 4.O-O Bc5 5.d4 Bxd4 6.Nxd4 Nxd4 7.Bg5 h6 8.Bh4 g5 9.f4`
    - **Aitken Variation** C54
      `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 -> 4.c3 Nf6 5.d4 exd4 6.cxd4 Bb4 7.Nc3 Nxe4 8.O-O Nxc3 9.bxc3 Bxc3 10.Ba3`
    - **Holzhausen Attack** C54
      `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 4.O-O Bc5 5.d4 Bxd4 6.Nxd4 Nxd4 7.Bg5 d6 8.f4 Qe7 9.fxe5 dxe5 10.Nc3`
    - **Steinitz Variation** C54
      `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 -> 4.c3 Nf6 5.d4 exd4 6.cxd4 Bb4 7.Nc3 Nxe4 8.O-O Bxc3 9.bxc3 d5 10.Ba3`
    - **Bernstein Variation** C54
      `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 -> 4.c3 Nf6 5.d4 exd4 6.cxd4 Bb4 7.Nc3 Nxe4 8.O-O Nxc3 9.bxc3 Bxc3 10.Qb3 d5`
    - **Krause Variation** C54
      `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 -> 4.c3 Nf6 5.d4 exd4 6.cxd4 Bb4 7.Bd2 Nxe4 8.Bxb4 Nxb4 9.Bxf7 Kxf7 10.Qb3 d5 11.…`
    - **Therkatz-Herzog Variation** C54
      `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 -> 4.c3 Nf6 5.d4 exd4 6.cxd4 Bb4 7.Nc3 Nxe4 8.O-O Bxc3 9.d5 Bf6 10.Re1 Ne7 11.Rx…`
  - **Hungarian Defense** C50
    `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 -> 3...Be7`
    - **Tartakower Variation** C50
      `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Be7 -> 4.d4 exd4 5.c3 Nf6 6.e5 Ne4`
  - **Paris Defense** C50
    `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 -> 3...d6`
  - **Rousseau Gambit** C50
    `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 -> 3...f5`
  - **Two Knights Defense** C55
    `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 -> 3...Nf6`
    - **Knight Attack** C57
      `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 -> 4.Ng5`
      - **Normal Variation** C57
        `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 4.Ng5 -> 4...d5`
    - **Modern Bishop's Opening** C55
      `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 -> 4.d3`
    - **Open Variation** C56
      `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 -> 4.d4`
    - **Ponziani-Steinitz Gambit** C57
      `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 -> 4.Ng5 Nxe4`
    - **Traxler Counterattack** C57
      `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 -> 4.Ng5 Bc5`
      - **Bishop Sacrifice Line** C57
        `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 4.Ng5 Bc5 -> 5.Bxf7`
      - **Knight Sacrifice Line** C57
        `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 4.Ng5 Bc5 -> 5.Nxf7`
      - **King March Line** C57
        `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 4.Ng5 Bc5 -> 5.Nxf7 Bxf2 6.Kxf2 Nxe4 7.Ke3`
    - **Perreux Variation** C56
      `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 -> 4.d4 exd4 5.Ng5`
    - **Fritz Variation** C57
      `1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 -> 4.Ng5 d5 5.exd5 Nd4`

- **Kloss Gambit** C57
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 -> 4.Ng5 d5 5.exd5 Nb4
- **Polerio Defense** C58
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 -> 4.Ng5 d5 5.exd5 Na5
  - **Bishop Check Line** C58
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 4.Ng5 d5 5.exd5 Na5 -> 6.Bb5
  - **Kieseritzky Variation** C58
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 4.Ng5 d5 5.exd5 Na5 -> 6.d3
  - **Bogoljubow Variation** C58
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 4.Ng5 d5 5.exd5 Na5 -> 6.Bb5 c6 7.dxc6 bxc6 8.Qf3
  - **Suhle Defense** C59
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 4.Ng5 d5 5.exd5 Na5 -> 6.Bb5 c6 7.dxc6 bxc6 8.Be2 h6
  - **Yankovich Variation** C58
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 4.Ng5 d5 5.exd5 Na5 -> 6.d3 h6 7.Nf3 e4 8.Qe2 Nxc4 9.dxc4 Bc5 10.Nfd2
  - **Göring Variation** C59
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 4.Ng5 d5 5.exd5 Na5 -> 6.Bb5 c6 7.dxc6 bxc6 8.Be2 h6 9.Nf3 e4 10.Ne5 Qc7
- **Ulvestad Variation** C57
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 -> 4.Ng5 d5 5.exd5 b5
  - **Kurkin Gambit** C57
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 4.Ng5 d5 5.exd5 b5 -> 6.Bf1 h6 7.Nxf7
- **Fried Liver Attack** C57
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 -> 4.Ng5 d5 5.exd5 Nxd5 6.Nxf7
- **Lolli Attack** C57
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 -> 4.Ng5 d5 5.exd5 Nxd5 6.d4
- **Max Lange Attack** C56
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.d4 exd4 4.Bc4 Nf6 5.O-O Bc5 6.e5
  - **Krause Variation** C56
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 4.d4 exd4 5.O-O Bc5 6.e5 Ng4 7.c3
  - **Loman Defense** C56
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.d4 exd4 4.Bc4 Bc5 5.O-O Nf6 6.e5 d5 7.exf6 dxc4 8.Re1 Be6 9.Ng5 g6
  - **Rubinstein Variation** C56
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 4.d4 exd4 5.O-O Bc5 6.e5 d5 7.exf6 dxc4 8.Re1 Be6 9.Ng5 Qd5 10.Nc3 Qf5 11.Nce4…
  - **Berger Variation** C56
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 4.d4 exd4 5.O-O Bc5 6.e5 d5 7.exf6 dxc4 8.Re1 Be6 9.Ng5 Qd5 10.Nc3 Qf5 11.g4…
- **Traxler Variation** C57
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 -> 4.Ng5 Bc5 5.Bxf7 Ke7 6.d4
  - **Trencianske-Teplice Gambit** C57
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 4.Ng5 Bc5 5.Bxf7 Ke7 6.d4
- **Pincus Variation** C57
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 -> 4.Ng5 d5 5.exd5 Nxd5 6.d4 Bb4
- **Fritz** C57
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 -> 4.Ng5 d5 5.exd5 Nd4 6.c3 b5 7.Bf1 Nxd5 8.Ne4
  - **Gruber Variation** C57
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 4.Ng5 d5 5.exd5 Nd4 6.c3 b5 7.Bf1 Nxd5 8.Ne4
- **Blackburne Variation** C58
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 -> 4.Ng5 d5 5.exd5 Na5 6.Bb5 c6 7.dxc6 bxc6 8.Qf3 cxb5
- **Colman Variation** C58
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 -> 4.Ng5 d5 5.exd5 Na5 6.Bb5 c6 7.dxc6 bxc6 8.Qf3 Rb8
- **Paoli Variation** C58
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 -> 4.Ng5 d5 5.exd5 Na5 6.Bb5 c6 7.dxc6 bxc6 8.Qf3 Qc7 9.Bd3
- **Steinitz Variation** C59
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 -> 4.Ng5 d5 5.exd5 Na5 6.Bb5 c6 7.dxc6 bxc6 8.Be2 h6 9.Nh3
- **Keidansky Variation** C56
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 -> 4.d4 exd4 5.e5 d5 6.Bb5 Ne4 7.Nxd4 Bc5 8.Nxc6 Bxf2 9.Kf1 Qh4
- **Maróczy Variation** C58
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 -> 4.Ng5 d5 5.exd5 Na5 6.d3 h6 7.Nf3 e4 8.Qe2 Nxc4 9.dxc4 Be7
- **Fegatello Attack** C57
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 -> 4.Ng5 d5 5.exd5 Nxd5 6.Nxf7 Kxf7 7.Qf3 Ke6 8.Nc3 Nb4 9.Qe4 c6 10.a3 Na6 11.d4…

- **Leonhardt Variation** C57
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 4.Ng5 d5 5.exd5 Nxd5 6.Nxf7 Kxf7 7.Qf3 Ke6 8.Nc3 Nb4 9.Qe4 c6 10.a3 Na6 11.d4 Nc7
- **Knorre Variation** C59
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 -> 4.Ng5 d5 5.exd5 Na5 6.Bb5 c6 7.dxc6 bxc6 8.Be2 h6 9.Nf3 e4 10.Ne5 Bd6 11.d4 Qc7…
- **Yurdansky Attack** C56
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.d4 exd4 4.Bc4 Nf6 5.O-O Nxe4 6.Re1 d5 7.Bxd5 Qxd5 8.Nc3 Qa5 9.Nxe4 Be6 10.Bg5 h6 11.Bh4 …
- **Classical Variation** C53
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 -> 3...Bc5 4.c3
  - **Closed Variation** C53
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.c3 -> 4...Qe7
  - **Albin Gambit** C50
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.O-O Nf6 5.c3
  - **Center Attack** C54
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.c3 -> 4...Nf6 5.d4
  - **Giuoco Pianissimo** C54
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.c3 -> 4...Nf6 5.d3
    - **with a6** C54
      1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.c3 Nf6 5.d3 -> 5...a6
    - **Albin Variation** C54
      1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.c3 Nf6 5.d3 -> 5...d6 6.b4
    - **with a5** C54
      1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.O-O Nf6 5.d3 a5 6.c3
    - **with h6** C54
      1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.O-O Nf6 5.d3 d6 6.c3 h6
    - **with a4 a5** C54
      1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.c3 Nf6 5.d3 -> 5...d6 6.O-O O-O 7.a4 a5
    - **Main Line** C54
      1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.c3 Nf6 5.d3 -> 5...d6 6.O-O O-O 7.Re1 a6 8.Bb3 Ba7 9.h3
  - **Center Holding Variation** C53
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.c3 -> 4...Qe7 5.d4 Bb6
  - **Greco Gambit** C54
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.c3 -> 4...Nf6 5.d4 exd4
    - **Dubov Italian** C54
      1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.c3 Nf6 5.d4 exd4 -> 6.b4
    - **Modern Line** C54
      1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.c3 Nf6 5.d4 exd4 -> 6.e5
    - **Traditional Line** C54
      1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.c3 Nf6 5.d4 exd4 -> 6.cxd4
    - **Anderssen Variation** C54
      1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.c3 Nf6 5.d4 exd4 -> 6.e5 d5 7.Bb5 Ne4 8.cxd4 Bb4
    - **Greco Variation** C54
      1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.c3 Nf6 5.d4 exd4 -> 6.cxd4 Bb4 7.Nc3 Nxe4 8.O-O Nxc3
    - **Main Line** C54
      1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.c3 Nf6 5.d4 exd4 -> 6.cxd4 Bb4 7.Nc3 Nxe4 8.O-O Bxc3
    - **Moeller-Therkatz Attack** C54
      1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.c3 Nf6 5.d4 exd4 -> 6.cxd4 Bb4 7.Nc3 Nxe4 8.O-O Bxc3 9.d5
    - **Moeller-Bayonet Attack** C54
      1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.c3 Nf6 5.d4 exd4 -> 6.cxd4 Bb4 7.Nc3 Nxe4 8.O-O Bxc3 9.d5 Bf6 10.Re1 Ne7 11.…
  - **with d5** C54
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.c3 -> 4...Nf6 5.d3 d5
  - **Mestel Variation** C53
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.c3 -> 4...Qe7 5.d4 Bb6 6.Bg5
  - **La Bourdonnais Variation** C53
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.c3 -> 4...d6 5.d4 exd4 6.cxd4 Bb6
  - **Eisinger Variation** C53
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.c3 -> 4...Qe7 5.d4 Bb6 6.d5 Nb8 7.d6
  - **Ghulam-Kassim Variation** C54
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.c3 -> 4...Nf6 5.d4 exd4 6.e5 Ne4 7.Bd5 Nxf2 8.Kxf2 dxc3 9.Kg3

- **Tarrasch Variation** C53
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.c3 -> 4...Qe7 5.d4 Bb6 6.0-0 d6 7.a4 a6 8.h3 Nf6 9.Re1
- **Evans Gambit** C51
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 -> 3...Bc5 4.b4
  - **Fontaine Countergambit** C51
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 -> 4...b5
  - **Hein Countergambit** C51
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 -> 4...d5
  - **Anderssen Variation** C51
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 -> 4...Bxb4 5.c3 Be7
    - **Cordel Line** C51
      1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 Bxb4 5.c3 Be7 -> 6.d4 Na5
  - **Main Line** C52
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 -> 4...Bxb4 5.c3 Ba5
  - **Mayet Defense** C51
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 -> 4...Bxb4 5.c3 Bf8
  - **McDonnell Defense** C51
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 -> 4...Bxb4 5.c3 Bc5
    - **Main Line** C51
      1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 Bxb4 5.c3 Bc5 -> 6.d4 exd4 7.0-0 d6 8.cxd4 Bb6
  - **Stone-Ware Variation** C51
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 -> 4...Bxb4 5.c3 Bd6
  - **Slow Variation** C52
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 -> 4...Bxb4 5.c3 Ba5 6.0-0
  - **Bronstein Defense** C52
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 -> 4...Bxb4 5.c3 Ba5 6.d4 d6
  - **Laroche Variation** C52
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 -> 4...Bxb4 5.c3 Ba5 6.d4 Nf6
  - **Leonhardt Countergambit** C52
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 -> 4...Bxb4 5.c3 Ba5 6.d4 b5
  - **Pierce Defense** C52
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 -> 4...Bxb4 5.c3 Ba5 6.d4 exd4
  - **Sokolsky Variation** C52
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 -> 4...Bxb4 5.c3 Ba5 6.d4 d6 7.Bg5
  - **Tartakower Attack** C52
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 -> 4...Bxb4 5.c3 Ba5 6.d4 d6 7.Qb3
  - **Alapin-Steinitz Variation** C52
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 -> 4...Bxb4 5.c3 Ba5 6.0-0 d6 7.d4 Bg4
  - **Anderssen Defense** C52
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 -> 4...Bxb4 5.c3 Ba5 6.0-0 Nf6 7.d4 exd4
  - **Compromised Defense** C52
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 -> 4...Bxb4 5.c3 Ba5 6.d4 exd4 7.0-0 dxc3
    - **Main Line** C52
      1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 Bxb4 5.c3 Ba5 6.d4 exd4 7.0-0 dxc3 -> 8.Qb3 Qf6 9.e5 Qg6 10.Nxc3 Nge7 11…
    - **Potter Variation** C52
      1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 Bxb4 5.c3 Ba5 6.d4 exd4 7.0-0 dxc3 -> 8.Qb3 Qf6 9.e5 Qg6 10.Nxc3 Nge7 11…
  - **Dufresne Defense** C52
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 -> 4...Bxb4 5.c3 Ba5 6.d4 exd4 7.0-0 d3
  - **Johner Defense** C52
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 -> 4...Bxb4 5.c3 Ba5 6.d4 exd4 7.0-0 b5
  - **Lasker Defense** C52
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 -> 4...Bxb4 5.c3 Ba5 6.0-0 d6 7.d4 Bb6
  - **Mieses Defense** C52
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 -> 4...Bxb4 5.c3 Ba5 6.d4 exd4 7.0-0 Nge7
  - **Sanders-Alapin Variation** C52
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 -> 4...Bxb4 5.c3 Ba5 6.0-0 d6 7.d4 Bd7
  - **Harding Variation** C51
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 -> 4...Bxb4 5.c3 Bc5 6.d4 exd4 7.cxd4 Bb4 8.Bd2

- **Richardson Attack** C52
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 -> 4...Bxb4 5.c3 Ba5 6.O-O Nf6 7.d4 O-O 8.Nxe5
- **Waller Attack** C52
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 -> 4...Bxb4 5.c3 Ba5 6.d4 exd4 7.O-O d6 8.Qb3
- **Morphy Attack** C51
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 -> 4...Bxb4 5.c3 Ba5 6.d4 exd4 7.O-O d6 8.cxd4 Bb6 9.Nc3
- **Fraser Attack** C51
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 -> 4...Bxb4 5.c3 Bc5 6.d4 exd4 7.O-O d6 8.cxd4 Bb6 9.Nc3 Bg4 10.Qa4
- **Göring Attack** C51
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 -> 4...Bxb4 5.c3 Bc5 6.d4 exd4 7.O-O d6 8.cxd4 Bb6 9.Nc3 Na5 10.Bg5
- **Ulvestad Variation** C51
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 -> 4...Bxb4 5.c3 Bc5 6.d4 exd4 7.O-O d6 8.cxd4 Bb6 9.d5 Na5 10.Bb2
- **Paulsen Variation** C51
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 -> 4...Bxb4 5.c3 Bc5 6.d4 exd4 7.O-O d6 8.cxd4 Bb6 9.d5 Na5 10.Bb2 Ne7
- **Levenfish Variation** C52
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 -> 4...Bxb4 5.c3 Ba5 6.d4 d6 7.Qb3 Qd7 8.dxe5 dxe5 9.O-O Bb6 10.Ba3 Na5 11.…
- **Steinitz Variation** C51
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 -> 4...Bxb4 5.c3 Bc5 6.d4 exd4 7.O-O d6 8.cxd4 Bb6 9.Nc3 Na5 10.Bg5 f6 11.Be3
- **Fraser-Mortimer Attack** C51
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 -> 4...Bxb4 5.c3 Bc5 6.d4 exd4 7.O-O d6 8.cxd4 Bb6 9.Nc3 Bg4 10.Qa4 Bd7 11.Q…
- **Mortimer-Evans Gambit** C51
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 -> 4...Bxb4 5.c3 Bc5 6.d4 exd4 7.O-O d6 8.cxd4 Bb6 9.Nc3 Bg4 10.Qa4 Bd7 11.…
- **Giuoco Pianissimo** C50
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 -> 3...Bc5 4.d3
  - **Lucchini Gambit** C50
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.d3 -> 4...f5
  - **Normal** C50
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 4.d3 Bc5
  - **Italian Four Knights Variation** C50
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.d3 -> 4...Nf6 5.Nc3
  - **Dubois Variation** C50
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.d3 -> 4...f5 5.Ng5 f4
  - **Canal Variation** C50
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.d3 -> 4...Nf6 5.Nc3 d6 6.Bg5
- **Jerome Gambit** C50
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 -> 3...Bc5 4.Bxf7
- **Rosentreter Gambit** C50
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 -> 3...Bc5 4.d4
- **Evans Gambit Accepted** C51
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 -> 3...Bc5 4.b4 Bxb4
- **Evans Gambit Declined** C51
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 -> 3...Bc5 4.b4 Bb6
  - **Cordel Variation** C51
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 Bb6 -> 5.Bb2
  - **Showalter Variation** C51
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 Bb6 -> 5.a4 a6 6.Nc3
  - **Hirschbach Variation** C51
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 Bb6 -> 5.b5 Na5 6.Nxe5 Qg5
  - **Lange Variation** C51
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 Bb6 -> 5.b5 Na5 6.Nxe5 Nh6
  - **Vasquez Variation** C51
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 Bb6 -> 5.b5 Na5 6.Nxe5 Qg5 7.Bxf7 Ke7 8.Qh5
  - **Hicken Variation** C51
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 Bb6 -> 5.b5 Na5 6.Nxe5 Qg5 7.Qf3 Qxe5 8.Qxf7 Kd8 9.Bb2
  - **Pavlov Variation** C51
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 Bb6 -> 5.b5 Na5 6.Nxe5 Nh6 7.d4 d6 8.Bxh6 dxe5 9.Bxg7 Rg8 10.Bxf7 Kxf7 11.Bx…
- **Scotch Invitation Declined** C56
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 -> 3...Nf6 4.d4 d6

- **Bird's Attack** C53
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 -> 3...Bc5 4.c3 Nf6 5.b4
- **Deutz Gambit** C50
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 -> 3...Bc5 4.O-O Nf6 5.d4
- **Scotch Gambit** C56
  1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 -> 3...Nf6 4.d4 exd4 5.O-O
  - **Double Gambit Accepted** C56
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 4.d4 exd4 5.O-O -> 5...Nxe4
  - **Janowski Defense** C56
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.d4 exd4 4.Bc4 Nf6 5.O-O d6
  - **Max Lange Attack** C56
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.d4 exd4 4.Bc4 Nf6 5.O-O Bc5
    - **Spielmann Defense** C56
      1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.d4 exd4 4.Bc4 Nf6 5.O-O Bc5 -> 6.e5 Ng4
    - **Long Variation** C56
      1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.d4 exd4 4.Bc4 Nf6 5.O-O Bc5 -> 6.e5 d5 7.exf6 dxc4 8.Re1 Be6 9.Ng5 Qd5 10.Nc3 Qf5 11.…
  - **de Riviere Defense** C56
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.d4 exd4 4.Bc4 Nf6 5.O-O Be7
  - **Nakhmanson Gambit** C56
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 4.d4 exd4 5.O-O -> 5...Nxe4 6.Nc3
  - **Walbrodt-Baird Gambit** C56
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.c3 Nf6 5.d4 exd4 6.O-O
  - **Canal Variation** C56
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.d4 exd4 4.Bc4 Nf6 5.O-O Nxe4 6.Re1 d5 7.Nc3
  - **Anderssen Attack** C56
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 4.d4 exd4 5.O-O -> 5...Nxe4 6.Re1 d5 7.Bxd5 Qxd5 8.Nc3
    - **Main Line** C56
      1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Nf6 4.d4 exd4 5.O-O Nxe4 6.Re1 d5 7.Bxd5 Qxd5 8.Nc3 -> 8...Qa5 9.Nxe4 Be6 10.Bd2 …
  - **Max Lange Attack Accepted** C56
    1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.O-O Nf6 5.d4 exd4 6.e5 d5 7.exf6 dxc4 8.Re1 Be6 9.fxg7

One-page memory sheet

Move-order pattern

```
1.e4 e5 2.Nf3 Nc6 3.Bc4 Bc5 4.b4 Bxb4 5.c3 Ba5
```

Plan chain

White	Nf3 -> Bc4 -> c3 -> d3 -> O-O
Black	Nc6 -> Nf6 -> Bc5 -> Be7 -> d6

Three rules to remember

1. Bc4, Nf3, c3, d3, O-O, Re1: then reroute the knight and strike with d4.
2. White builds with c3-d3, then d4 or a kingside regroup; Black frees the game with ...d5 or ...Na5.
3. White wants d4 at the right time; Black wants ...d5 for equality or to trade the bishop.

Pawn structure in one line

A flexible centre (c3/d3/e4) with the bishop on c4 eyeing f7. Often a slow, closed-ish structure where d4 is the central break.